METADIGITALGOODS · ARCHIVAL EDITION

Stay Safe Online: Senior Defense Guide

How to Spot Phone, Text & Email Scams in Seconds

The 5 Red Flags of a Scam Call or Text

1. URGENCY & FEAR: Scammers claim your bank account, Medicare, or Amazon order has an 'urgent problem' that must be fixed in the next 10 minutes.

2. GIFT CARDS OR WIRE TRANSFERS: No real company, government agency, or utility will EVER ask you to pay with Apple/Target gift cards or crypto.

3. POP-UP COMPUTER WARNINGS: If a loud beep or screen pop-up says 'Call Microsoft Support Immediately', close the browser or turn off the computer—never call that number!

4. SECRET REQUESTS: Anyone telling you 'Don't tell your family or bank teller why you are withdrawing cash' is 100% a scammer.

Our Family's Safe Verification Rule

When in doubt, HANG UP! Then call a trusted family member or call the official number printed on the back of your bank card.